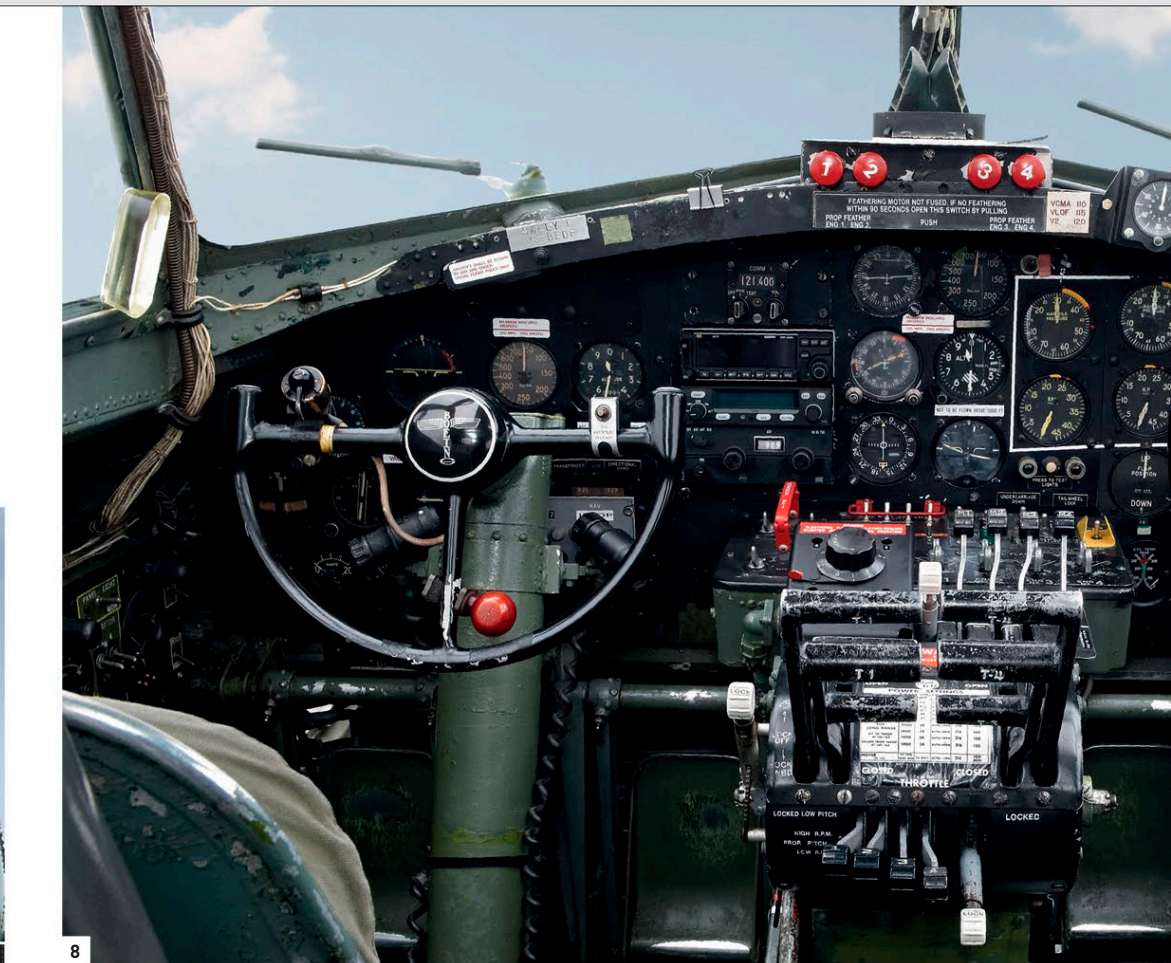
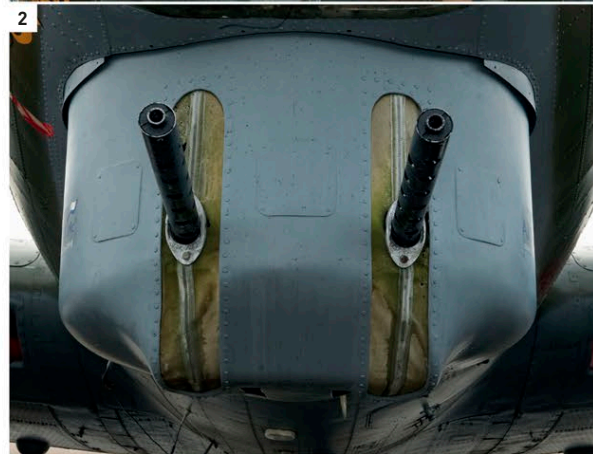


THE EXTERIOR

The B-17 belonged to a new generation of all-metal monoplane aircraft with enclosed cockpits, and was built to be tough. From the outset, Boeing had envisioned the new bomber as an aerial battleship. When a journalist reported that the prototype looked like a “flying fortress,” Boeing saw the value in the name and trademarked it.

1. Transparent Plexiglass nose 2. Chin guns remotely controlled by bombardier 3. Waist machine-gun position 4. Gun sight for tail-gunner's station 5. Wright Cyclone radial engine with Hamilton Standard hydromatic propeller 6. Mainwheel with oleo suspension 7. Sperry swiveling ball turret



THE COCKPIT

The pilot and copilot of the B-17 were afforded excellent front and side visibility from the cockpit, the “office” being designed to be spacious and efficient. The pilot would sit in the left-hand seat, the basic flight instruments—altimeter, airspeed indicator, turn-and-bank indicator, and rate-of-climb indicator—being located in the central panel. The copilot, in the right-hand seat, would also be responsible for monitoring the engine controls, which were located on the right-hand side of the panel. The central console contained the throttle controls, fuel switches, fuel mixture, and propeller-pitch controls.

8. The “office”—the B-17 flight deck 9. Propeller-feathering controls 10. Panel containing flight and engine instruments 11. Copilot's control stick featuring Boeing logo 12. Propeller pitch controls 13. Throttle controls

